# TWO STORIES, ONE COUNTRY: UNDERSTANDING IRELAND THROUGH FILM

watching *Belfast* and *Philomena*

# STEP INTO THE STORY – WHERE DO YOU STAND?

Position yourself across the room according to whether you agree with the statement or not. Be prepared to explain your opinion.

**Family is more important than where you come from.**

**The past should stay in the past.**

**Religion should influence political decisions.**

**People should always try to find out the truth about their past.**

**Violence is necessary to fight injustice.**

# TRAILER INSIGHTS

You are going to watch two trailers. Name the central topic of each movie.

| BELFAST | PHILOMENA |
| --- | --- |
| | |


VOM REGISSEUR VON DIE QUEEN
PHILOMENA
EINE BEWEGENDE KOMÖDIE ÜBER EINE UNGEWÖHNLICHE FREUNDSCHAFT
OSCAR®-PREISTRÄGERIN
JUDI DENCH
STEVE COOGAN
NOMINIERT FÜR 3 GOLDEN GLOBES®
VENEDIG 2013 GEWINNER BESTES DREHBUCH
"Gelächter, Tränen, Szenenapplaus" DER TAGESSPIEGEL
"Diese Geschichte berührt alle" BERLINER ZEITUNG
SQUAREONE ENTERTAINMENT UND UNIVERSUM FILM PRÄSENTIEREN
BBC FILMS
www.philomena-film.de
/philomena.derfilm
universum film


A KENNETH BRANAGH FILM
CAITRÍONA BALFE
ACADEMY AWARD® WINNER
JUDI DENCH
JAMIE DORNAN
CIARÁN HINDS
AND INTRODUCING
JUDE HILL
BELFAST
OUR MEMORIES MAKE US
TELLURIDE
ONLY IN THEATERS NOVEMBER 12
TORONTO

# FIND YOUR MOVIE

Decide which movie you want to watch.

Philomena: meet in room _____

Belfast: meet in room _____

# BELFAST: HISTORICAL CONTEXT

Get together in groups of 3 people.

In your group, pick a category. Create a digital information card (A5) highlighting the most important information about your topic. Make sure that everyone understands your facts ( ! No chatGPT-copy-paste ! )

Upload your information card to the Edumap.

Be prepared to give a 1-min-overview about your topic in front of the class.

# BELFAST: HISTORICAL CONTEXT

**The Troubles:** What were the Troubles and when did they start?

**Catholics vs Protestants:** Why were these two groups in conflict?

**Unionists and Nationalists:** What political goals did the groups have?

**Northern Ireland and the United Kingdom:** Why does Northern Ireland belong to the UK?

**Segregation in Northern Ireland:** How were communities divided in everyday life?

**Violence and Riots in 1969:** What happened in Belfast when the conflict escalated?

**The Role of the British Army:** Why were British soldiers sent to Northern Ireland?

**Growing up during the Troubles:** How did the conflict affect children and families?

**Emigration from Northern Ireland:** Why did many families leave Belfast?

**Religion and Identity in Northern Ireland:** Why was religion connected to politics and identity?

# PHILOMENA: HISTORICAL CONTEXT

Get together in groups of 3 people.

In your group, pick a category. Create a digital information card (A5) highlighting the most important information about your topic. Make sure that everyone understands your facts ( ! No chatGPT-copy-paste ! )

Upload your information card to the Edumap.

Be prepared to give a 1-min-overview about your topic in front of the class.

# PHILOMENA: HISTORICAL CONTEXT

**The Catholic Church in Ireland:** Why did the church have such strong influence in Irish society?

**Unmarried Mothers in the 1950s:** How were young pregnant women treated?

**Magdalene Laundries:** What were they and what happened there?

**Mother and Baby Homes:** What institutions existed for unmarried mothers?

**Adoption Practices in Ireland:** How were children adopted and why were many sent abroad?

**Irish Society and Moral Rules:** What social norms existed in Ireland in the mid-20th century?

**Irish Immigration to the United States:** Why were many Irish children adopted by American families?

**Journalism and Investigative Reporting:** Why did journalists start investigating these stories?

**Apologies and Historical Reconciliation:** How did Ireland deal with this past later?

**The Real Story of Philomena Lee:** What happened in the true story behind the film?

# MOVIE TIME

Please work on the Multiple-Choice-Questions while watching *Belfast*.



# MOVIE TIME

Please work on the Multiple-Choice-Questions while watching *Philomena*.



# BEHIND THE STORIES: CHARACTER INTERVIEWS FORMAL REQUIREMENTS

Imagine you are a radio moderator interviewing a character from the film. Your task is to create and perform an interview that helps the audience better understand the characters‘ experiences, thoughts and motivations.

- Work in pairs (2 people).
- duration: 2 minutes
- a natural conversation
- Practice the interview to perform it fluently and correctly.
- After the interview the audience may ask the character additional questions.
- Upload your script to the Edumap.

# BEHIND THE STORIES: CHARACTER INTERVIEWS CONTENT REQUIREMENTS

Write 6 – 8 interview questions + answers.

Your questions should cover the following topics:

- The character‘s experiences in the film
- Important decisions
- Emotions and personal conflicts
- Relationships with other characters
- The message of the story

# BELFAST: LIST OF CHARACTERS

Buddy

Ma

Pa

Granny

Pop

Billy Clanton

Moira

Miss Lewis

Catherine

# PHILOMENA: LIST OF CHARACTERS

Philomena

Young Philomena (as a teenager)

Martin Sixsmith

Sister Hildegarde

Jane Lee

Pete Olsson

Michael Hess

# PEER FEEDBACK

**Answer the following questions.**

Was the story of the film easy to understand from the interview?

Did the characters show their emotions, motivations or opinions?

Did the interview highlight important themes of the film (e.g. religion, conflict, family, power)?

Did the interview help you understand the message of the film?

**Finish the sentence beginnings.**

- One thing I learned about the film was …
- One question I still have about the story is …
- One thing the group did particularly well was …